

BACKGROUND

Point of Care Ultrasound (**POCUS**) is a bedside diagnostic tool increasingly used in clinical practice. While its clinical utility is well-established, its impact on patient satisfaction remains underexplored. This study evaluates whether POCUS improves satisfaction among patients with congestive heart failure, focusing on communication, diagnostic confidence, and overall care quality.

METHOD

Our study was conducted at Lakeland Regional Health and included 60 patients who were **randomized** into two groups: 30 patients received POCUS as part of their care, while 30 received standard care without POCUS. Satisfaction was assessed using the PSQ-18 at discharge, and results were analyzed for statistical significance with a threshold of $p < 0.05$.

RESULTS

The POCUS group reported **higher mean satisfaction** in general satisfaction (4.06 ± 0.91 vs. 4.00 ± 0.71 , $p = 0.777$) and technical quality (3.44 ± 0.47 vs. 3.31 ± 0.55 , $p = 0.329$), though these differences were not statistically significant.

Interpersonal manner was higher in the non-POCUS group (3.44 ± 0.50 vs. 3.08 ± 0.78 , $p = 0.038$) and significant, as was communication (3.75 ± 0.46 vs. 3.15 ± 0.49 , $p < 0.001$).

Financial aspects (2.42 ± 1.00 vs. 2.31 ± 0.84 , $p = 0.646$), time spent with doctor (3.50 ± 0.70 vs. 3.20 ± 0.80 , $p = 0.128$), and accessibility and convenience (2.80 ± 0.60 vs. 3.00 ± 0.70 , $p = 0.240$) **did not differ significantly** between groups.

	POCUS Mean (SD)	NON-POCUS Mean (SD)	p value
General Satisfaction	4.06 ± 0.91	4.00 ± 0.71	0.777
Technical Quality	3.44 ± 0.47	3.31 ± 0.55	0.329
Interpersonal Manner	3.08 ± 0.78	3.44 ± 0.50	0.038
Communication	3.15 ± 0.49	3.75 ± 0.46	<0.001
Financial Aspects	2.42 ± 1.00	2.31 ± 0.84	0.646
Time Spent with Doctor	3.50 ± 0.70	3.20 ± 0.80	0.128
Accessability and Convenience	2.80 ± 0.60	3.00 ± 0.70	0.24

Figure 1: Forest plot of primary and secondary outcomes

*Interpersonal manner and communication scores were **LOWER** with POCUS.*



Internal Medicine Residents performing POCUS

CONCLUSION

POCUS may improve technical quality and patient satisfaction, but its overall impact on care perceptions is nuanced. While it provides diagnostic benefits, integrating POCUS should consider broader satisfaction factors. Further research with a larger sample size will validate these results and explore other confounders.